

Same Object, Different AOK Teacher Notes

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 30-40 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	same-object-different-aok

Big idea: One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

Overview

Students prepare for exhibition-style thinking by analysing one object through many knowledge lenses.

Student Prompt

Inspect Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Same Object, Different AOK Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

Actual Lesson Questions and Key

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How does context change what an object helps us know?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how one object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Ready-to-Use Examples

- A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs.
- A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence.
- A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes.

Suggested Timing

Stage	Teacher move	Watch for
1	Place the object in the centre of the room or slide.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
2	Groups rotate through AOK stations and add one insight at each station.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
3	After the rotation, groups identify which AOK produced the most surprising knowledge.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
4	Students formulate a TOK exhibition-style commentary.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
Debrief	Move from the activity result to a TOK knowledge question.	Students distinguishing method, evidence, interpretation, and overclaiming.

Teacher Language

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Common Misconceptions

- Students may apply one AOK's standard of evidence to all knowledge claims.
- Students may equate certainty with value or usefulness.

Assessment Look-Fors

- Compares standards of evidence across at least two AOKs.
- Explains how a claim changes when method, context, or audience changes.

Differentiation and Adaptations

- Short lesson: use only the first example, one response grid, and one debrief question.
- Long lesson: add a second round where students revise the method and compare outcomes.
- Low-tech option: run with printed cards, sticky notes, and a board tally.

Extension Tasks

- Design a second version of the activity that tests the same knowledge issue in another AOK.
- Find a real-world example where the same knowledge problem matters outside the classroom.
- Write a 150-word TOK exhibition-style commentary using the activity as the object context.

Related Activities

- What Counts as Evidence?
- Reliability Ranking
- Music and Emotion Experiment